



ACKO (INSURTECH)

• VARUN DUA, FOUNDER

> **KEY INVESTORS** Accel, Elevation Capital, Amazon

> **FUNDING** \$484 million so far

► **ACKO has revolutionised India's insurance landscape by eschewing traditional methods. This it achieved by fusing insurance with tech, and eliminating unnecessary paperwork. Behind ACKO is Varun Dua, the former co-founder of insurance aggregator Coverfox, who is a 'shark' on Shark Tank India Season 3. Dua's impressive track record persuaded investors to inject an initial \$30 million into ACKO before it was even launched. Starting in 2016, the start-up's uniqueness lies in its offering of a range of bite-sized insurance solutions, like rider insurance, ticket cancellation, and more. ACKO's digital-only model contributed to its growth. In five years, it has distributed policies to over 78 million unique customers, issuing more than one billion insurance policies. In FY23, ACKO posted total revenue of ₹966 crore and a loss of ₹551 crore, per the company.** **BT**

— BY TEENA JAIN KAUSHAL

ADDVERB TECHNOLOGIES (MOBILE ROBOTICS & WAREHOUSE ENTERPRISE SOFTWARE)

(CLOCKWISE FROM LEFT)

• BIR SINGH, CO-FOUNDER & CHIEF BUSINESS OFFICER • PRATEEK JAIN, CO-FOUNDER & COO
• SATISH SHUKLA, CO-FOUNDER & CMO • SANGEET KUMAR, CO-FOUNDER & CEO

> **KEY INVESTORS** Reliance Industries, Jalaj Dani, GAIL India

> **FUNDING** RIL: \$132 million in 2022; Jalaj Dani: \$11 million in 2018 and 2019; GAIL India: \$85,000 in 2018

► **SATISH SHUKLA, CO-FOUNDER** and CMO at Addverb Technologies, exemplifies how one can apply existing professional experience seamlessly onto a new venture. Originating from his tenure at Asian Paints in the early 2010s, Shukla, along with three former colleagues-turned-business-partners—Sangeet Kumar,

CEO & Co-founder; Bir Singh, CBO & Co-founder and Prateek Jain, COO & Co-founder—leveraged their diverse expertise in the founding of the Noida-based automated solutions provider in 2016. The timing too proved right as GST was being implemented and the country was on the cusp of the impending industrial automation wave.

Their former boss at Asian Paints, Jalaj Dani, initially an investor at Addverb, later came on board as Chairman, complementing the team. Addverb's current turnover stands at ₹450 crore, boasting over 750 employees and a global presence in Malaysia, Dubai, Germany, Netherlands, the US, and India. Shukla is now aiming for a ₹1,000-crore revenue, targeting 60 per cent from international markets, a significant increase from the current 20 per cent. **BT**

— BY ARNAB DUTTA

